Salome Yichi Zhang

Dawn

For Gaia Quartet

January, 2025

Program Note:

This piece is the first movement of the intended string quartet series, "Insomnia, " dedicated to Gaia Quartet. The writing aims to illustrate the frustration of someone being unable to fall asleep. They lie in bed during the darkest hours and witness the sunrise. Even when the sky brightens, they cannot fall asleep. Therefore, the piece is meant to convey a sense of frustration and franticness. With occasional harmonies, the composition signifies the moments when the person enters a state of drowsiness, yet still cannot drift into dreams.

Performance Note:

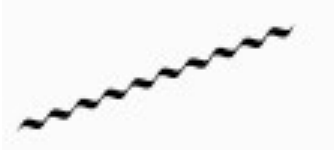
ord.- Ordinary bowing position

s.t - Sul Tasto

s.p - Sul Ponticello
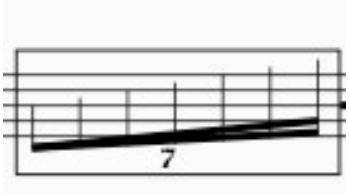


Continue the gesture



Gently touch the strings, and glide-light touch

Non-pitched note-the player could play any preferred note



Play the given rhythm aleatorically, with pitches that you desire



Over-pressure the bow
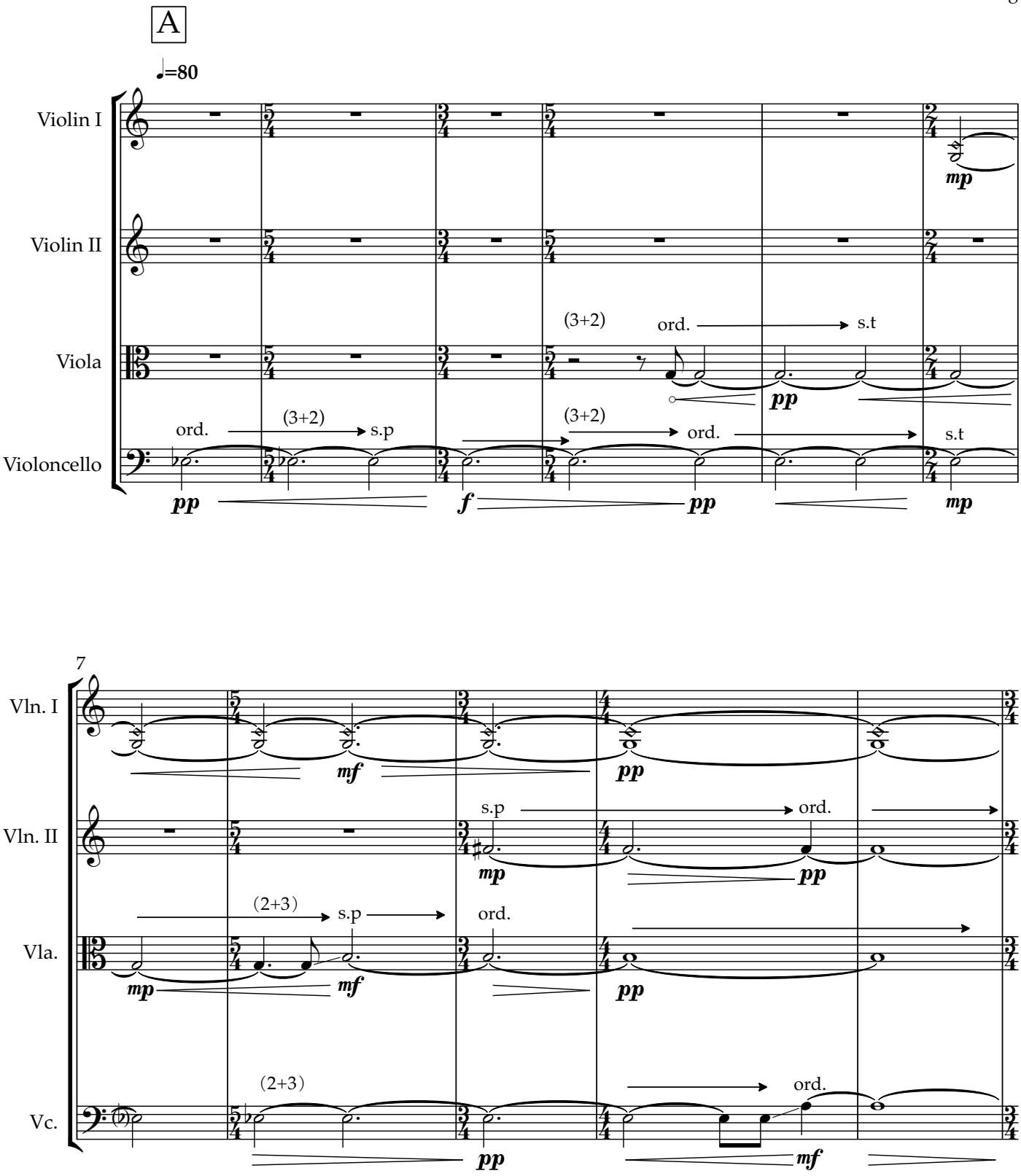


Release the over-pressure
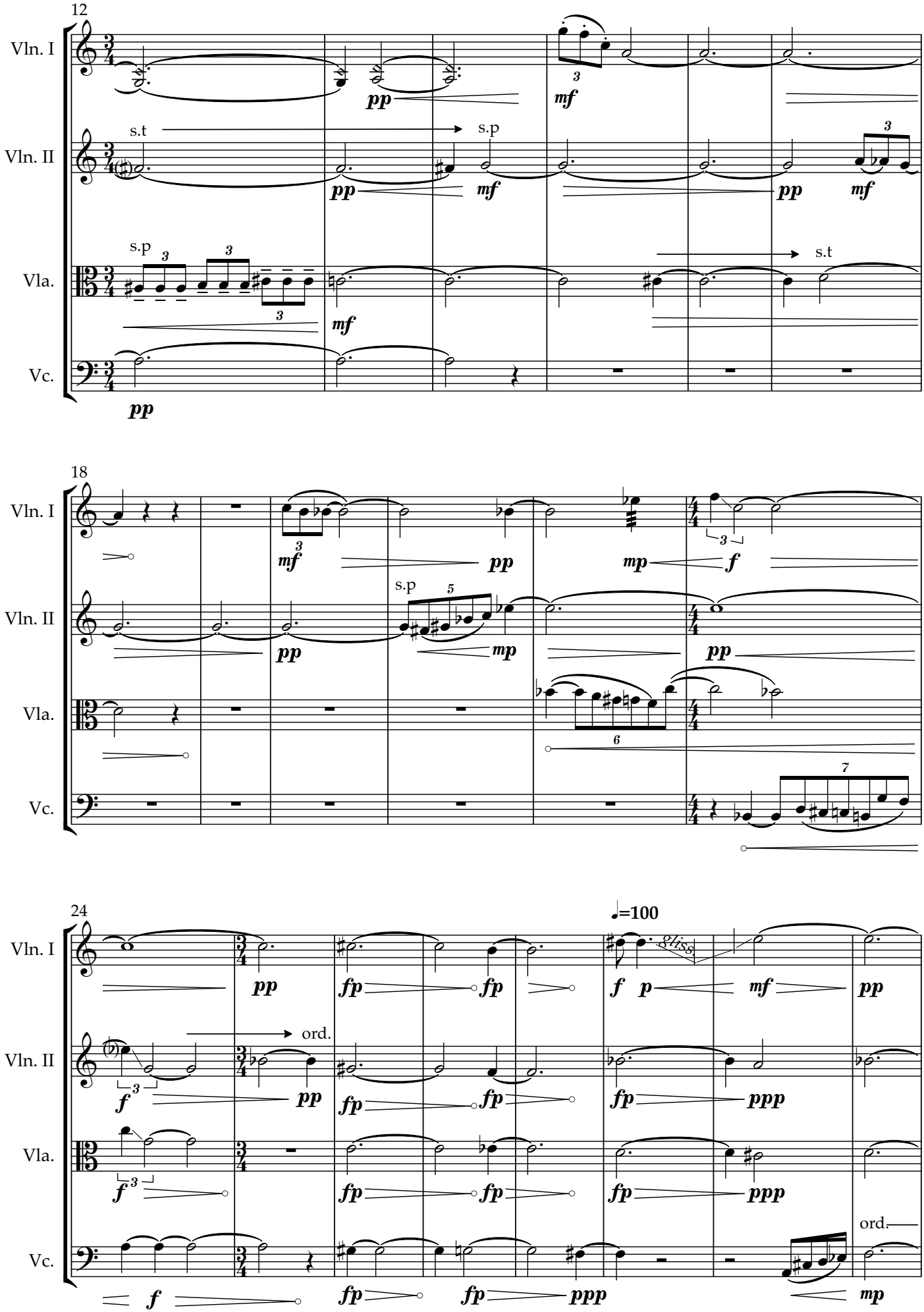
For Gaia Quartet
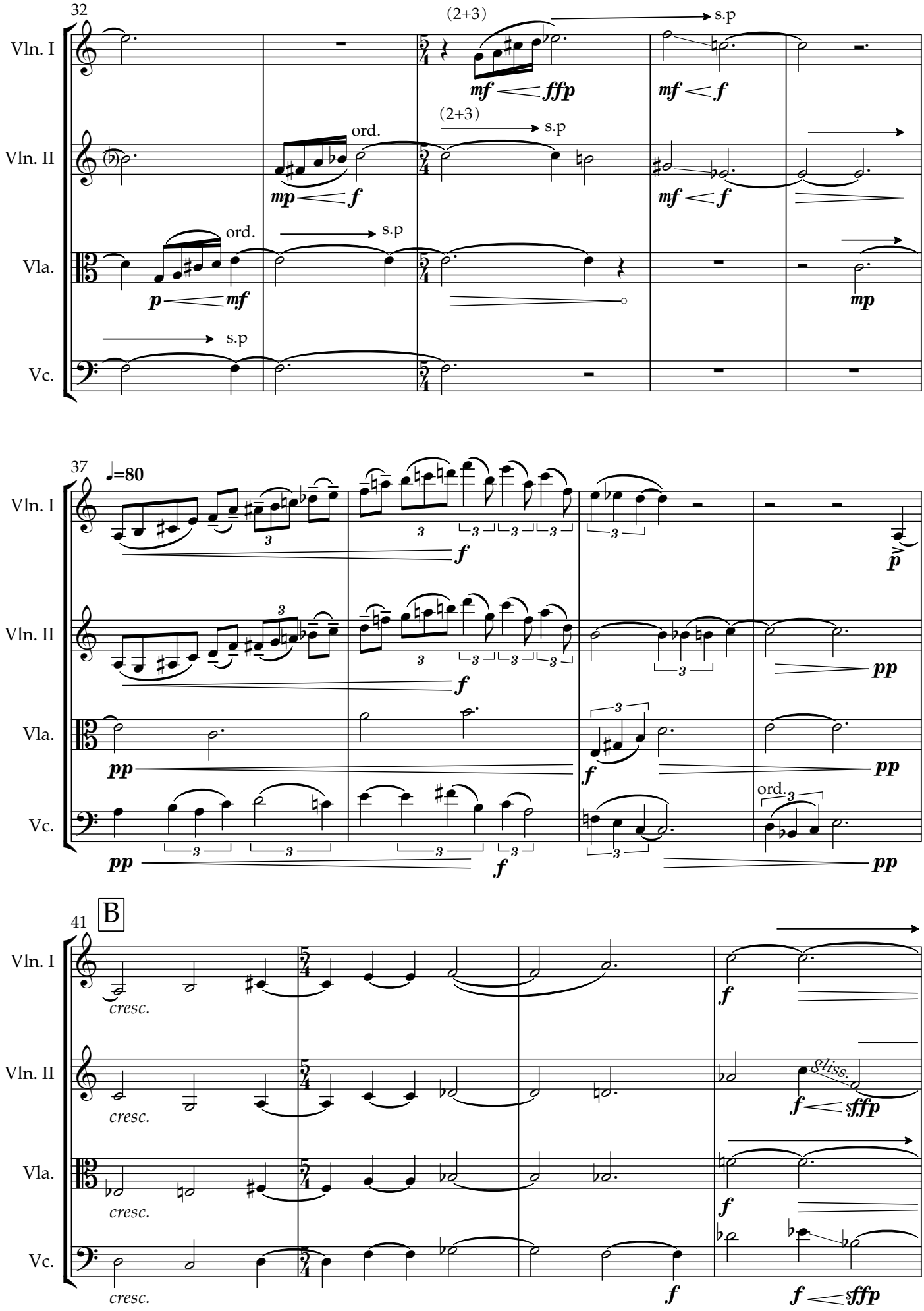
Dawn

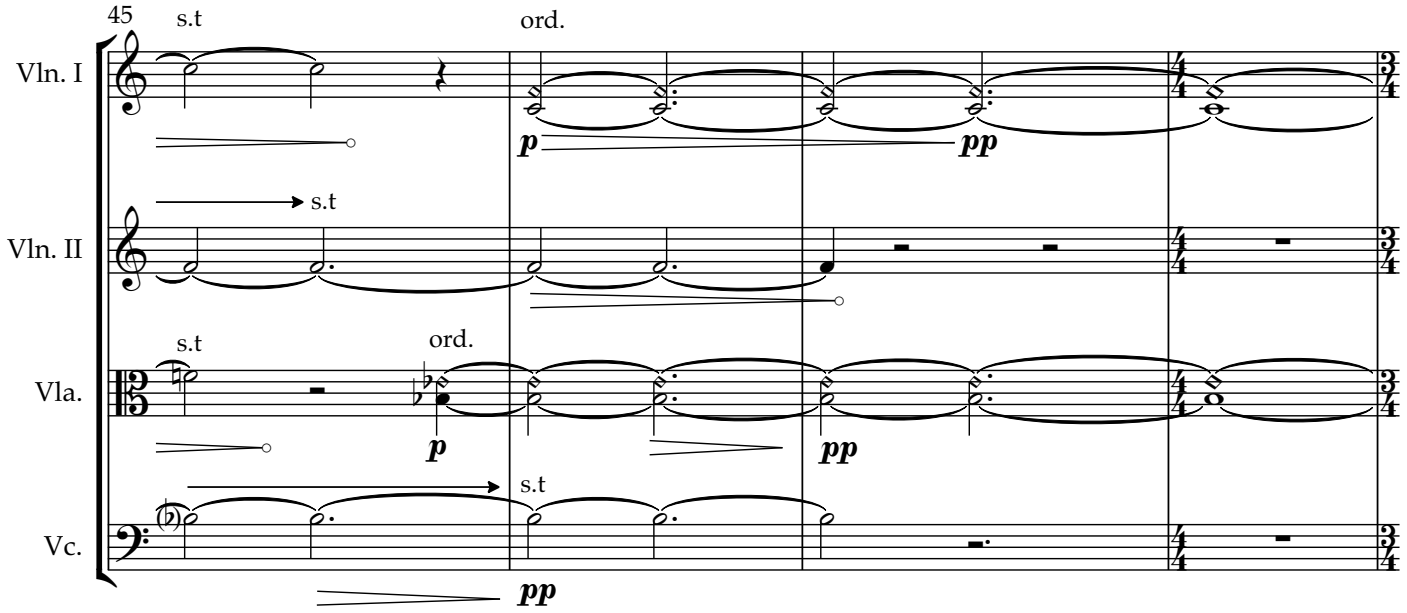
Dream is just a shade of dimly-lit-sky

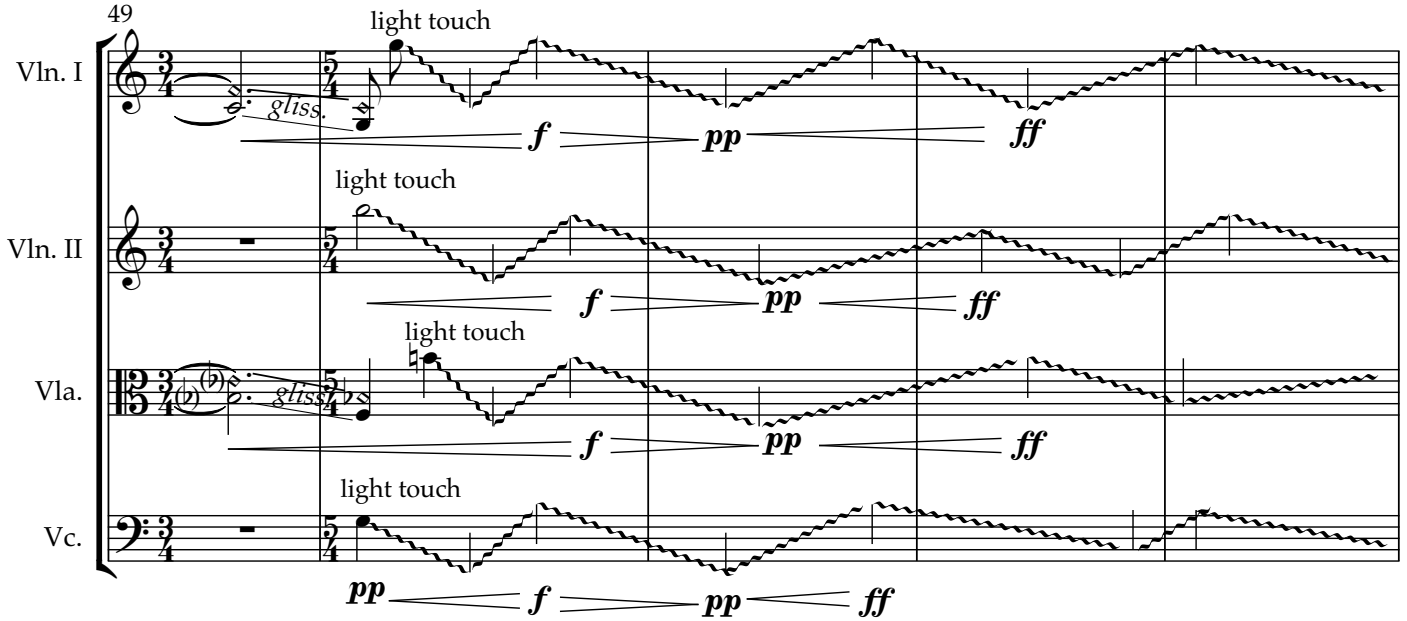
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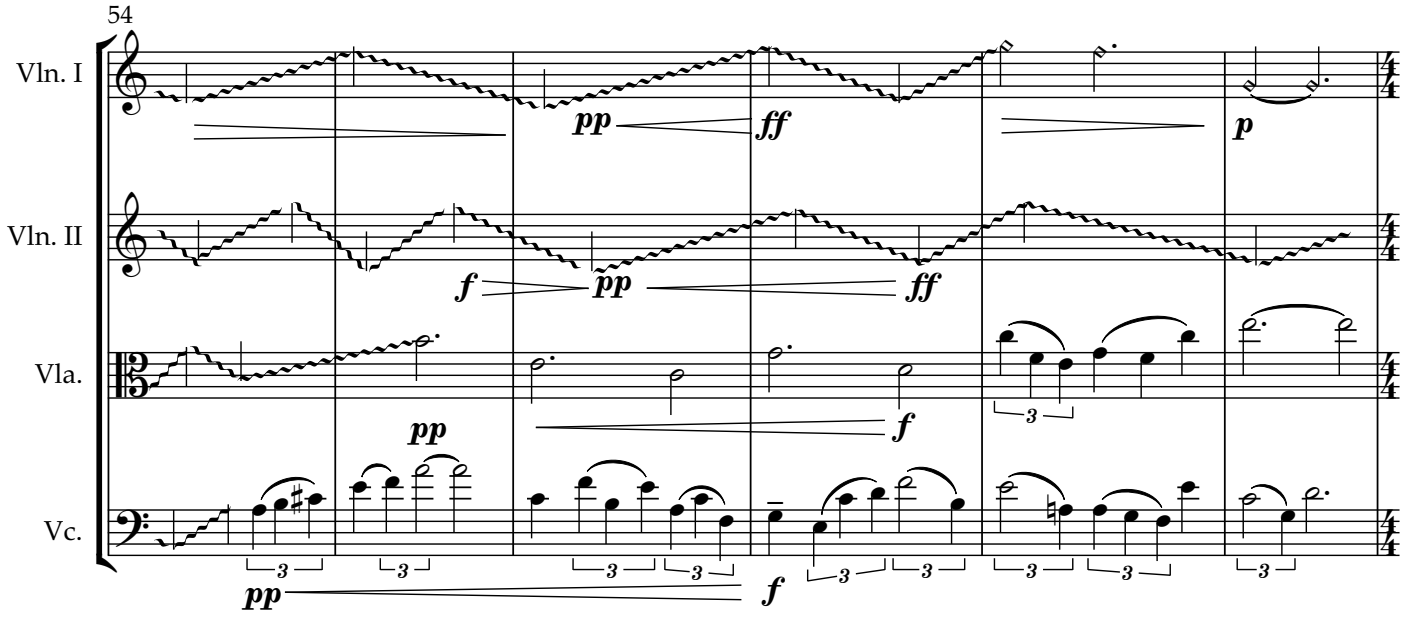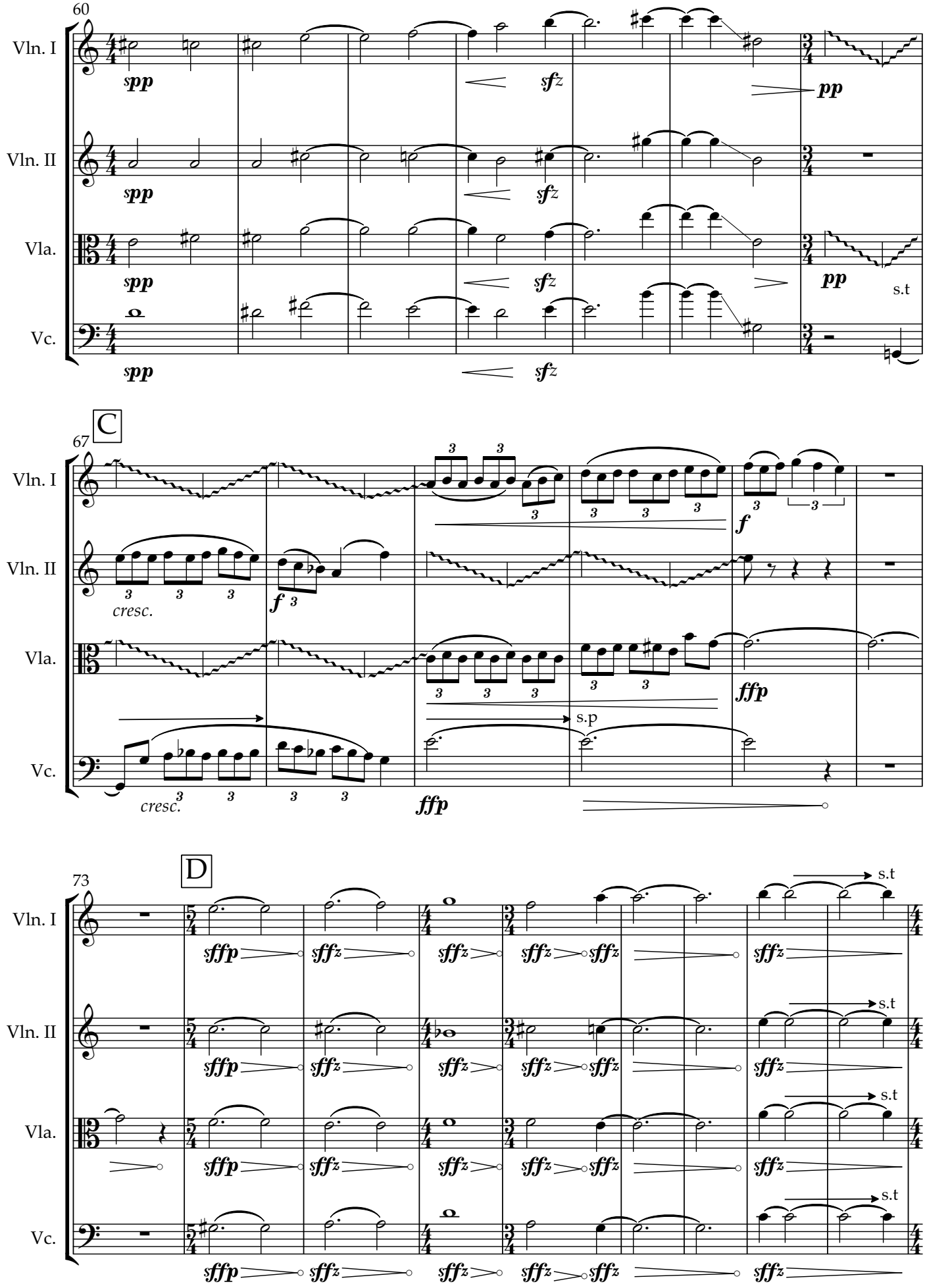



12
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
s.t
s.p
s.p
s.t
18
s.p
24
♩=100
ord.
ord.
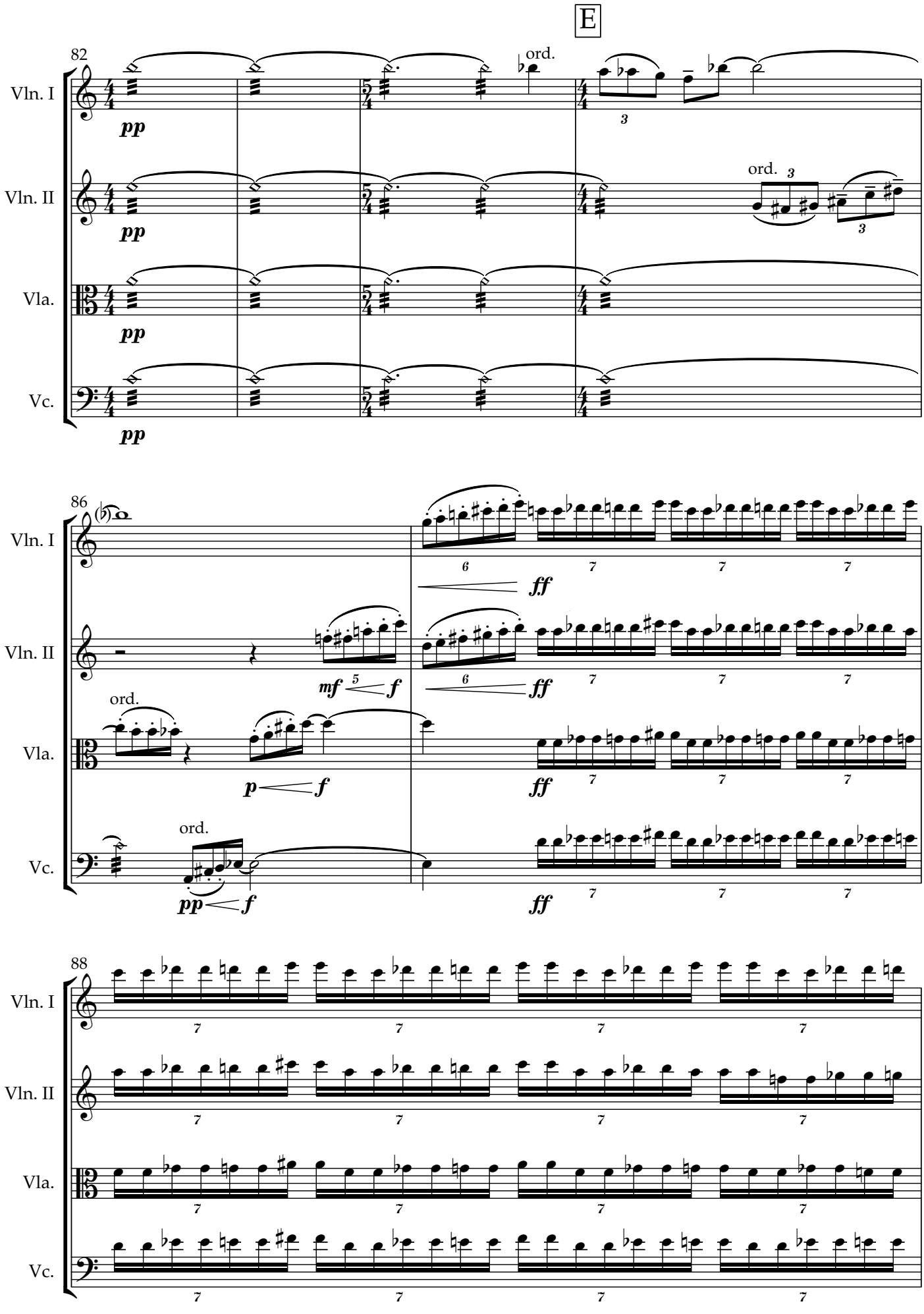

32
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
(2+3)
s.p
mf ffp
mf f
ord.
mp f
p mf
mp
37
=80
f
pp
ord.
41
B
cresc.
gliss.
sffp
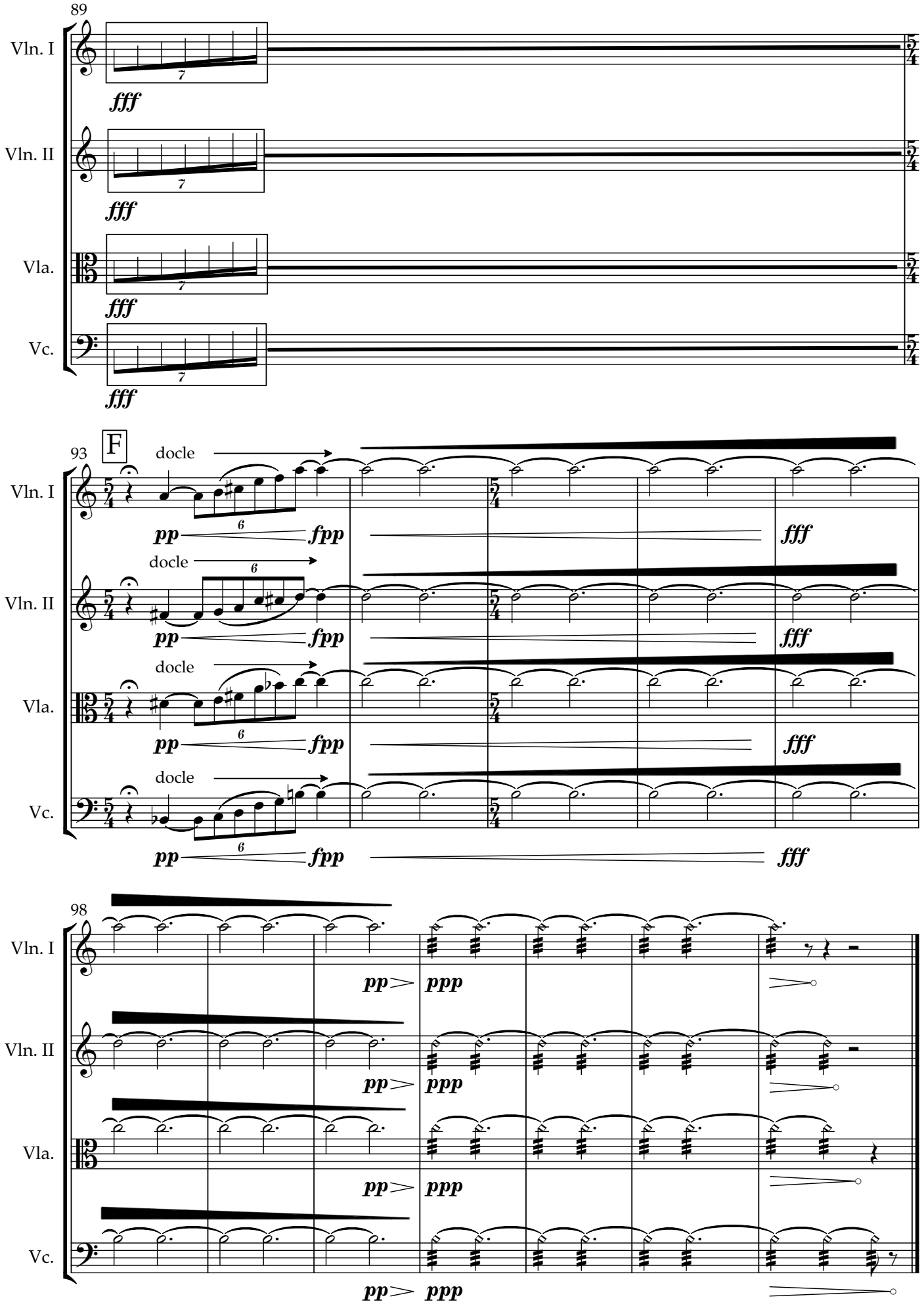

45
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
s.t
ord.
p
pp


49
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
light touch
gliss.
f
pp
ff


54
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
pp
ff
f
p
3


60
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
spp
sfz
pp
s.t
C
67
cresc.
f
ffp
s.p
D
73
sffp
sffz
s.t


E
82
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
pp
ord.
3
86
ff
mf
f
p
88


89
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
fff
93
F
docle
pp
fpp
fff
98
ppp